

## Windows Is CONning Me

**Q** Why can't I create a folder named "CON" or "PRN" in Windows XP?

**Preetham Shenoy**

**A** Interesting question! You aren't allowed to create folders with names that are the same as the ones that have been used for various devices on a PC since the DOS era.

"CON" refers to "console" in DOS.

Similarly, "PRN" refers to "printer," as also

"LPT1," "LPT2," etc., and "COM1," "COM2," etc. refer to the communication ports.

There happens to be a workaround for this. To create a folder called "con" in the C: drive, open a command prompt. Type in the following commands:

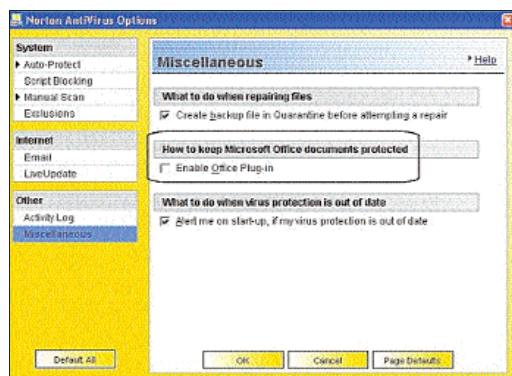
`mkdir \\.\c:\con` (This will create a folder named "con")

`dir C:\con` (This will list the contents of the directory, so you know the directory was indeed created!)

You may also be able to view the folder using Windows Explorer, but you will not be able to enter or delete it. In order to delete the folder, type in `rmdir \\.\c:\con` at the command prompt.

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**A** To disable the virus scan on opening any Office document, launch Norton AntiVirus. Click on Options. On the left-hand side at the bottom, you will see a section called "Miscellaneous" under "Other." Click it. Now on the right-hand side, uncheck the box against



Disable the MSOffice Plugin in Norton Antivirus

"Enable Office Plug-in," and click OK. Office documents will no longer be scanned for viruses when they're opened.

## Don't Do That You'll Go Blind!

**Q** My PC has an AMD Athlon XP 2400+, 256 MB of RAM, and a VIA/S3G KM400/KN400 onboard graphics chipset. I installed the Cue Club Demo from your magazine's CD. Normally, the game runs fine, but after I resume from hibernation and run it, the screen goes blank and the PC hangs.

**Puneet Abrol**

**A** The problem you're experiencing seems to be due to the display driver not properly supporting the power management features of Windows XP. A possible solution is to download an updated driver for your display adapter from the manufacturer's Web site.

## Cards That Crawl

**Q** My system configuration is a Pentium 4 2.4 GHz, 384 MB of RAM, and a GeForce FX 5200 128 MB card. The problem is that most of my games run slowly, and even my 3DMark05 score is very low. I've installed the latest drivers for my graphics card but in vain.

**Naju R**

**A** The nVidia GeForce FX 5200 is a low-end graphics card, and you should not expect it to perform as a high-end card. You might be able to play most games on this card at the lowest settings. Don't be fooled by the 128 MB that comes with the card—it simply does not have the bandwidth and power to make full use of that much memory.

## Upgrade Or Else

**Q** I have an Intel Pentium 4 1.6 GHz, 256 MB of RAM, and an nVidia GeForce4 MX 440 32 MB graphics card. Dungeon Siege Demo II, King Kong Demo, and X-Men Legend 2 Demo don't run on my PC.

I get a message: "Sync out of range." I've tried almost all possible methods to improve the performance of PC: I've altered the graphics card settings, the size of the page file, etc.

The problem seems to be with the graphics card: when I try King Kong Demo, the system gives a message: "Out of video memory, try to run at a lower resolution."

**Jitendra Barate**

**A** The "Sync out of range" message means that the game, when loaded, forces the screen refresh rate to a value not supported by your monitor.

You will either need to set the refresh rate in the game, or you will have to use the DirectX Diagnostic Tool to force the game to use a refresh rate supported by your monitor.

To do this, click on **Start > Run**, type "DXDiag" and hit [Enter]. Click the "More Help" tab, click the "Override" button, click "Override value", and enter a refresh rate such as 60 Hz, which should be comfortable for any monitor. Click OK. You could experiment by gradually increasing this value.

The games you've mentioned are the latest games, and require a system with a higher configuration than yours in order to run without any issues.

That's not to say they won't run on your system, but that you will have to reduce the graphics details in-game. Download and install the latest display drivers from [www.nvidia.com](http://www.nvidia.com).

If you really want to enjoy the game and turn up the details, you'll need to upgrade your graphics card! ■



### Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to [sos@jasubhai.com](mailto:sos@jasubhai.com), and we might answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!